

Fnu Mohbat

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SUMMARY

Final-year Ph.D. candidate in Computer Science with hands-on research experience in multi-modal learning, large language models (LLMs), knowledge graphs (KGs), and graph neural networks (GNNs). Proficient in training and deploying LLMs, VLMs, and RAG systems on multi-GPU clusters.

Seeking a applied researcher role to contribute to cutting-edge AI development in NLP, CV, or multi-modal systems.

EDUCATION

Ph.D. Computer Science , Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute, Troy, NY <i>Dissertation:</i> Knowledge Graph Enhanced Large Language Models for Food Understanding. <i>Advisor:</i> Mohammed J. Zaki	01/2021 - 08/2025
MS Electrical Engineering , Lahore University of Management Sciences <i>Thesis:</i> Content Based Image Retrieval Through Deep Learning.	08/2016 - 06/2018
BS Electrical Engineering , COMSATS Institute of Information Technology Undergraduate Exchange , Ivy Tech Community College, Fort Wayne, IN	09/2009 - 06/2014 08/2012 - 05/2013

SKILLS SUMMARY

Languages:	Python, C/C++, MATLAB, C#
AI/ML Frameworks:	PyTorch, TensorFlow, Keras, LangChain, LlamaIndex, VectorDB (FAISS, Chroma)
CV & Robotics:	OpenCV, ROS, PCL
Data Science Tools:	Pandas, NumPy, SciPy, Jupyter, Git, Docker, MLflow, Weights & Biases
Platforms:	IBM Power9, HPC, NVIDIA Jetson, Raspberry Pi

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute <i>Graduate Research Assistant, Advisor: Mohammed J. Zaki</i>	Troy, NY 08/2021 - Present
- Conducting research to enhance Large Language Models (LLMs) and Multi-Modal Models (MMMs) by integrating Knowledge Graphs (KGs) through Retrieval-Augmented Generation (RAG), resulting in a 30 – 50% improvement in personalized food recipe recommendations. - Proposed multistage instruction tuning and custom loss for improving language vision models, resulting a 16-point gain in SacreBLEU and a 6-point increase in ROUGE-L scores. - Improved document understanding, caption generation, and text summarization through LLM (LLaMA, Phi, Mistral) and MMM (LLaVA, miniGPT). - Facilitated collaboration between IBM Research and Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute, combining academic and industry expertise to foster innovation (2021-2023).	
Nokia Bell Labs <i>ML Research Intern,</i>	New Providence, NJ 05/2025 - 08/2025
Developing agentic AI systems to improve customer experience and assist in fault analysis and resolution, leveraging domain-specific data such as time series, customer feedback, and system logs.	
IBM Thomas J. Watson Research Center <i>Summer Extern, Mentors: Keerthiram Murugesan</i>	Remote 05/2023 - 08/2023
Investigated the impact of Stable Diffusion (SD) generated images on visual concept manipulation in Multi-Modal Models (MMMs), revealing that the biased visuals exacerbate toxicity and bias in generated text compared to unbiased visual and text-only inputs.	
IBM Thomas J. Watson Research Center <i>Summer Extern, Manager: Ashish Verma</i>	Yorktown Heights, NY 05/2022 - 08/2022
Improved generalization of document AI models by 15 – 30% on out-of-distribution (OOD) data through novel Transformer-GNN integration, reducing OOD detection error rates and enhancing real-world adaptability.	
IBM Thomas J. Watson Research Center <i>Summer Extern, Mentors: Ashish Verma, Catherine Finegan-Dollak</i>	Remote 05/2021 - 08/2021
- Fine tuned transformer models and object detection models for document text understanding tasks including classification and key-value prediction. - Annotated a proprietary visual document dataset and fine-tuned and evaluated models (Bert, LayoutLM) on it.	
Lahore University of Management Sciences <i>Research Associate in National Agriculture Robotics Lab</i>	Lahore, Pakistan 04/2019 - 12/2020
Led 5-10 researchers in developing deep learning and IoT solutions for water quality assessment via foreign object detection, implemented on Raspberry Pi and NVIDIA Jetson Nano.	

- Researched model compression techniques, developing a Teacher-Class network that significantly enhanced accuracy and reduced parameters by 10-30x compared to traditional single-student methods.
- Co-supervised 4 undergraduate and 2 master's students, drafted proposal for research grant proposals and industrial collaborations.

Lahore University of Management Sciences

Lahore, Pakistan

Research Assistant in Computer Vision & Graphics Lab

06/2017 - 03/2019

- Proposed a residual dyad network that amplified image retrieval by 22 mAP points on remote sensing images.
- Developed fixed-wing V-TOL UAV for autonomous target identification, payload delivery (5kg, 10km range), with 60-min flight time.
- Wrote modification codes for GTA-V to collect 100,000 road scene images with car parameters, and trained Convolutional Neural Networks (CNNs) to predict speed and steering angles for autonomous vehicle control within the game environment.
- Conducted tutorials in Computer Vision and Deep Learning classes and mentored senior year projects.

Agatos Pvt. Pakistan, Automation Engineer

08/2014 - 10/2016

- Analyzed project requirements, programmed PLCs, HMI/SCADA systems, and commissioned on site, and participated in sales meetings with customers.

PUBLICATIONS

11. KERL: Knowledge-Enhanced Personalized Recipe Recommendation using Large Language Models, Fnu Mohbat & Mohammed J. Zaki. The Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2025.
10. Knowledge Graph-Enhanced LLM for Food Recommendation through Question Answering, Fnu Mohbat & Mohammed J. Zaki. Towards Knowledgeable Foundation Models at AAAI, 2025. [PDF](#).
9. LLaVA-Chef: A Multi-modal Generative Model for Food Recipes, Fnu Mohbat & Mohammed J. Zaki. Proceedings of the 33rd ACM International Conference on Information and Knowledge Management (CIKM), 2024. [PDF](#).
8. Beyond Visual Augmentation: Investigating Bias in Multi-Modal Text Generation, Fnu Mohbat, Vijay Sadashivaiah, Keerthiram Murugesan, Amit Dhurandhar, Ronny Luss & Pin-Yu Chen. Fourth Workshop on Trustworthy Natural Language Processing (TrustNLP), at NAACL 2024. [PDF](#).
7. GVdoc: Graph-based Visual Document Classification, Fnu Mohbat, Mohammed J. Zaki, Catherine Finegan-Dollak & Ashish Verma. Findings of the 61st Association for Computational Linguistics (ACL), 2023. [PDF](#).
6. Teacher-Class Network: A Neural Network Compression Mechanism, Shaiq Munir Malik, Fnu Mohbat, & Murtaza Taj. The 32nd British Machine Vision Conference, 2021. [PDF](#).
5. Trash Detection on Water Channels, Mohbat Tharani, Abdul Wahab & Murtaza Taj. International Conference on Neural Information Processing, 2021. [PDF](#)
4. Cross-view Image Retrieval - Ground to Aerial Image Retrieval Through Deep Learning, Numan Khurshid, Talha Hanif, Mohbat Tharani & Murtaza Taj. International Conference on Neural Information Processing (ICONIP), Sydney, Australia. Dec 12-15, 2019. [Link](#)
3. A Residual-Dyad Encoder Discriminator Network for Remote Sensing Image Matching, Numan Khurshid*, Mohbat Tharani*, Murtaza Taj & Faisal Qureshi. IEEE Transaction on Geo-science and Remote Sensing, Nov, 2019. [Link](#)
2. Dimensionality Reduction Using Discriminative Autoencoders for Remote Sensing Image Retrieval, Mohbat, Tooba Mukhtar, Numan Khurshid & Murtaza Taj, The 20th International Conference on Image Analysis and Processing (ICAIP), Trento, Italy, September 9-13, 2019. [Link](#)
1. Use of Greendrone UAS System for Maize Crop Monitoring, Ahmad Kamal Nasir & Mohbat Tharani¹, The International Archives of the Photogrammetry, Remote Sensing and Spatial Information Sciences, 2017. [PDF](#)

PROFESSIONAL SERVICES

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| • Served as a session chair at ACM Conference on Information and Knowledge Management (CIKM) | 2024 |
| • Reviewer: Computer Vision and Pattern Recognition (CVPR) | 2025 |
| • Reviewer: ACM International Conference on Information and Knowledge Management (CIKM) | 2024 |
| • Reviewer: ACM SIGKDD International Conference on Knowledge Discovery and Data Mining (KDD) 2024 - 2025 | |
| • Reviewer: European Conference on Computer Vision (ECCV) | 2024 |
| • Reviewer: IEEE Winter Conference on Applications of Computer Vision (WACV) | 2020 - 2025 |

HONORS AND AWARDS

- AAAI 2025 Travel/Volunteer scholarship award (\$700 + Registration) 12/2025
- Invited talk and poster at ACM International Conference on AI in Finance (ICAIF), Brooklyn, NY. 2024
- NAACL 2024 registration award for volunteering virtual sessions 06/2024
- Founding member and Vice President, Computer Science Graduate Council at RPI 2021 - 2022
- Qualified UAV Medical Express Challenges 2018 in Australia, only 13 out of 55 teams qualified 09/2018
- Received 90% financial aid for Masters degree at Lahore University of Management Science, Pakistan 2016-2018
- National ICT R&D merit scholarship for the complete bachelor's degree. (120/7000 applicants). 2009-2014
- NESAC UGRAD Exchange Scholarship (fully funded two semesters) (3/5000 applicants) 2012-2013
- Inspiring Intern certificate from the State Department during NESAC exchange program (3 out of 90) 4/2013

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Rensselaer Polytechnic Institute, *Teaching Assistant*

- Computational Vision (CSCI-6270); Instructor: Chuck Stewart Spring, 2025
- Computer Science I (CSCI-1100); Instructor: Uzma Mushtaque Fall 2024
- Operating Systems (CSCI-4210); Instructor: David Goldschmidt Summer 2024
- Computer Organization (CSCI-2500); Instructor: Prof. George Slota Spring 2021

Lahore University of Management Sciences, *Teaching Assistant*

- Deep Learning (CS-437/5317); Instructor: Prof. Murtaza Taj Spring 2019, Spring 2020
- Robot Motion Planning (EE-562); Instructor: Prof. Muhammad Abubakr Fall 2018

Ivy Tech Community College *Teaching Assistant*

- Introduction to database: Oracle 11g; Instructor: Dr. John M. Heise Fall 2012
- Introduction Industrial Technology; Instructor: Dorothy R. Barse Fall 2012, Spring 2013